CAC STAFF RACING 2026

SAILING INSTRUCTIONS

Calshot Activity Centre | Sailing Area A

April – September 2026

1 Rules

These races are governed by The Racing Rules of Sailing (RRS) 2025–2028 except where changed by these Sailing Instructions.

2 Organising Authority

The organising authority is Calshot Activity Centre (CAC).

3 Official Notices

All official notices, including any changes to these Sailing Instructions, will be communicated via the designated staff racing WhatsApp group. Competitors are responsible for checking for notices before each racing evening.

4 Racing Schedule

4.1 Series Structure

Racing is divided into three series. Series 2 is the main summer series. Four dates across the season will be designated as special events with their own separate scoring; these dates are included in the list below and will be confirmed on the official notice board when known.

Series	Date Range	Evenings	Est. Races
Series 1	14 Apr – 2 Jun	3*	6–9
Series 2 (Main)	23 Jun – 28 Jul	5*	10–15
Series 3	11 Aug – 8 Sep	3*	6–9

* Some dates within each series may be designated as special events and will not count towards series standings.

4.2 Race Dates

All racing and special event dates are listed below. Special event dates will be confirmed on the official notice board.

- 14 April
- 28 April
- 12 May
- 2 June
- 23 June
- 30 June
- 7 July
- 14 July
- 21 July
- 28 July
- 11 August
- 18 August

- 25 August
- 8 September

4.3 Sign On and Warning Signal

Competitors must be signed on by 1750. The warning signal for the first race of each evening will be made at 1800. No warning signal will be made after 2000.

5 Sign On

The sign-on whiteboard will be displayed at the race office. Available boats will be listed; competitors claim boats on a first-come, first-served basis. Sign on closes when the Race Officer launches.

A competitor who has signed on but does not race any race that evening will be recorded as Did Not Compete (DNC) rather than Did Not Start (DNS).

6 Boats

Boats are centre-supplied dinghies (Picos and Fusions). Picos and Fusions will be scored together without handicap adjustment, as they have been found to be equivalent in performance at this venue.

If other boat types are brought into use, Portsmouth Yardstick (PY) handicap calculations will be applied for those boats only. This will be notified before the evening.

Competitors shall not modify boats or equipment in any way. All equipment supplied with the boat shall remain in the boat while afloat. Any damage must be reported to the Race Officer on return ashore.

7 Racing Area

All racing will take place in Sailing Area A unless otherwise notified before the start of the evening.

8 Safety

8.1 Personal Buoyancy

A buoyancy aid or lifejacket shall be worn at all times while afloat. This changes RRS 1.2.

8.2 Whistle

All competitors shall carry a whistle while afloat. The Race Officer may check for whistles at any time. A competitor found to be racing without a whistle will receive a 20% scoring penalty applied to that race. This changes RRS A5.

8.3 Helmets

The Race Officer may require competitors to wear a helmet. This decision will be made on the day and may vary depending on conditions and the experience of those racing. The Race Officer's decision is final. A competitor who launches without the required helmet will be disqualified from all races sailed that evening.

8.4 Safety Boat

A safety boat will be on the water for all racing. The provision of safety boat cover does not reduce a competitor's own responsibility for their safety.

8.5 Risk Statement

RRS 3 states: "The responsibility for a boat's decision to participate in a race or to continue to race is hers alone." By launching, each competitor accepts responsibility for their own safety and their decision to go afloat.

9 Courses

Courses will be set by the Race Officer on the water and communicated to competitors before each start by flags, boards or verbal instruction.

The Race Officer may shorten a race in progress by displaying flag S with two sound signals at the finishing line.

10 Time Limit

All equipment must be off the water no later than 30 minutes before sunset. The Race Officer will not start a race that cannot reasonably be completed within this limit. Any race in progress at this time will be abandoned.

11 The Start

Races will be started using the following sequence:

Time	Flag	Sound
3 min	Flag B ↑ displayed (Warning)	1 sound
2 min	Flag P ↑ displayed (Preparatory)	1 sound
1 min	Flag P ↓ removed (1-minute warning)	1 sound
0 – Start	Flag B ↓ removed (Starting signal)	1 sound

Times are taken from the visual signals. The absence of a sound signal shall be disregarded. Flag P being removed at 1 minute serves as the 1-minute warning signal. This changes RRS 26.

The starting line is between the Race Officer's vessel (or designated mark) at the starboard end and a port-end mark.

A boat that does not start within 5 minutes of her starting signal will be scored Did Not Start (DNS) without a hearing. This changes RRS A5.

If one or more boats are on the course side of the starting line at her starting signal, the Race Officer will display Flag X with one sound signal (individual recall). A boat that is OCS must return to the pre-start side of the line and restart. A boat that fails to return will be scored OCS without a hearing. This changes RRS 29.1 and A5.

12 The Finish

The finishing line will be indicated by the Race Officer. If the Race Officer is absent when a boat finishes, the boat shall report her finishing position to the Race Officer at the first reasonable opportunity.

13 Retirement

Any boat retiring from a race shall inform the Race Officer as soon as possible. If a competitor returns to shore, they shall contact the Race Officer by radio as soon as practicable after landing.

14 Penalty System

14.1 On-Water Penalties

The following penalties apply:

- Mark-touching: one-turn penalty (RRS 44.1). The one-turn penalty already applies to rule 31 mark-touching under the RRS – this SI confirms that option applies here.
- Right-of-way infringement: two-turn penalty as per RRS 44.2.

A boat that has carried out a penalty turn shall inform the Race Officer as soon as practicable after finishing.

14.2 Protests

This series operates in the spirit of fair and open racing. Competitors are expected to follow the rules knowing that the whole fleet is watching. The protest procedure is kept simple and decided quickly so that racing is not disrupted.

A competitor who wishes to protest shall inform the Race Officer before the next starting sequence begins. The Race Officer will adjudicate on the water where practicable.

In "he said, she said" situations where there are no witnesses, the balance of probability will be given to no foul having occurred.

The Race Officer may instruct a boat to carry out penalty turns if a breach is observed directly.

15 Scoring

15.1 Points System

The Low Points Scoring System (RRS Appendix A) applies. One point is awarded for first place, two for second, and so on.

15.2 Minimum Races

A minimum of 3 races must be completed to constitute a valid series.

15.3 Discards

The number of race scores that may be discarded is calculated using the expression int(s/3), where s is the number of races sailed:

Races Sailed	Discards
1–2	0
3–5	1
6–8	2
9–11	3
12–14	4
15	5

15.4 Ties

Series ties will be broken using the most wins method. If still tied, the most second places, then most third places, and so on, excluding discarded scores. This is in accordance with RRS Appendix A8.

15.5 Scoring Codes

Code	Meaning	Points	Discardable
DNF	Did Not Finish	Boats signed on + 1	Yes
DNS	Did Not Start (signed on, present that evening)	Boats signed on + 1	Yes
DSQ	Disqualified	Boats signed on + 1	Yes
DNC	Did Not Compete (not present that evening)	Boats in series + 1	Yes
WRK	On duty / work commitment (verified by Race Officer against duty rota)	Average of non-discarded race scores – calculated at series end	Yes

DNF, DNS and DSQ are scored based on the number of competitors signed on at the start of the evening, not the total number in the series. This protects competitors on low-attendance evenings.

WRK is applied by the Race Officer from the duty rota. Competitors may not self-declare WRK. A competitor who is present but chooses not to race will be scored DNC.

15.6 Redress

A competitor may be eligible for redress in the following circumstances:

- A competitor is fouled by another boat that does not take a penalty turn, and this is reported to the Race Officer before the next starting sequence.
- A competitor stops to assist a person or vessel in distress. The competitor shall inform the Race Officer as soon as practicable.

Redress will be awarded at the Race Officer's discretion in accordance with RRS 62.

15.7 Results

Results will be published on the staff racing WhatsApp group after each evening. Series standings will be updated and posted following each racing night.

15.8 Overall Standings

An overall standings will be maintained across all three series. The overall score is the sum of a competitor's nett scores from each individual series. Each series is scored independently with its own discards.

16 Prizes

Prizes are awarded at two levels:

Series prizes: a small prize will be awarded to the winner of each individual series (Series 1, Series 2 and Series 3), subject to a minimum of 2 competitors having completed that series.

Overall trophies: awarded at the end of the season to the overall standings winners across the following categories, subject to the minimum entry requirements below:

Category	1st Place	2nd Place	3rd Place
Overall	Min. 2 competitors	Min. 3 competitors	Min. 5 competitors
Female	Min. 2 competitors	Min. 3 competitors	Min. 5 competitors
Staff	Min. 2 competitors	Min. 3 competitors	Min. 5 competitors
Non-DI	Min. 2 competitors	Min. 3 competitors	Min. 5 competitors

Special event prizes will be announced separately for each event.

17 Special Events

Four special events will be held during the season. Dates will be confirmed on the official notice board. Separate sailing instructions will be issued for each event where required.

- Long Distance Race
- Pub Run Race
- Team Race Evening – team racing rules apply
- Additional special event – TBC

Results from special events do not count towards any series standings.

18 General Conduct

Competitors shall comply with reasonable requests from race officials.

These are fun races – but the rules are real. Race fairly, look after each other on the water, and enjoy yourselves.

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APPENDIX A

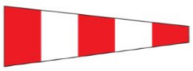
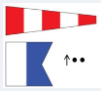
FLAG SIGNALS

Quick reference for all flag signals used in CAC Staff Racing 2026. This is not a substitute for the Race Signals section of the RRS.

A1 Starting Sequence

Time	Flag	Name	Meaning
3 min		B – Bravo (class flag)	Warning signal. Start countdown begins.
2 min		P – Papa (Blue Peter)	Preparatory signal. 2 minutes to start.
1 min		P – removed	1-minute warning. Flag P comes down.
0 – Go		B – removed	Start. Flag B comes down. Race begins.

A2 Postponement and End of Racing

Signal	Flag(s)	Name	Meaning
AP		Answering Pennant	Races not yet started are postponed. Warning signal 1 minute after removal.
AP over A		AP + Alpha	No more racing tonight. Return ashore.
N over A		November + Alpha	All races abandoned. No more racing tonight. Return ashore.

A3 Race Signals

Signal	Flag	Name	Meaning
S		S – Sierra	Course shortened. Finish at the next mark or gate as instructed by the Race Officer.
N		N – November	All races that have started are abandoned. Return to the starting area.
X		X – X-ray (Individual Recall)	One or more boats are OCS. Return to the pre-start side of the line and restart. Boats that fail to return are scored OCS without a hearing.
U		U – Uniform (U Flag Rule)	OCS at the 1-minute signal. Any boat over the line is disqualified without a hearing. If the race is abandoned and restarted, the disqualified boat may take part in the new start. This differs from

			the black flag rule, where a boat that is OCS is excluded from any restart.
First Sub		First Substitute (General Recall)	The whole fleet restarts. All boats return to the start area. 6 sounds. A new warning signal will be made once the flag is lowered.

A4 Sound Signals

Sound	Meaning
1 sound	Accompanies each flag change in the starting sequence
3 sounds	Abandon – used when the Race Officer abandons without a flag signal (e.g. safety situation)
6 sounds	General recall – First Substitute displayed. New start for this class.
Repeated sounds	Danger or attention – look to the Race Officer immediately

A5 Quick Reference

- Flag B up – 3 minutes to start
- Flag P up – 2 minutes to start
- Flag P down – 1 minute to start
- Flag B down – start now
- Flag X up – individual recall, one or more boats OCS, return and restart
- Flag U in effect at start – OCS at 1 minute = DSQ; may restart only if race is subsequently restarted
- First Substitute up – general recall, whole fleet restarts, 6 sounds
- Flag S up during a race – course shortened, finish next time past the line
- Flag N up during a race – race abandoned, return to start
- AP up before a race – start delayed
- AP over A – no more racing tonight, head ashore
- N over A – all races abandoned, no more racing tonight, head ashore

Appendix A | CAC Staff Racing 2026